territories of Arunachal Pradesh & Mizoram

- New State of Sikkim Act in 1975
- State of Arunachal Pradesh Act, State of Mizoram act 1986: Formation of the States of Mizoram and Arunachal Pradesh
- State of Goa Act in 1987
- Reorganisation Act, 2000: Formation of Chhattisgarh
- Reorganisation Act, 2000: Formation of Uttarakhand
- Bihar Reorganisation Act, 2000: Formation of Jharkhand
- Andhra Pradesh Reorganisation Act, 2014: Formation of Telangana

The formation of States remains a complex issue owing to various forms of diversity, such as culture, caste, religion, language, ethnicity, and even how a particular territory is geographically placed. Therefore, the undercurrent of the constant strife for a separate State lies in access to resources and more importantly asserting identity.



Activity

Draft a Commission to explore suggestions other than linguistic diversity to be a reason to create States. How can it contribute to the progress of the country?

7.3 India after Reorganisation

After 1947 – Independent India

During the British Colonial period, there were about 600 administrative units as the Princely States. Depending on the geographical, cultural, and religious preferences, people were given a choice to either stay back in the new country India or equally new country Pakistan. Meanwhile, there were other countries that were formed such as Bhutan. The current administrative units were formed between 1947 and 1950. Some places retained their boundaries from British India such as Mysore, Hyderabad, and Bhopal.

Amidst religious tensions, post-independence witnessed two nations, India and Pakistan. The independence of India led to the close of colonial rule and in the reorganisation of States, which were mostly based on languages, and the rest based on a geographical and cultural basis. Hence, the new nation of India was restructured and reorganised, which instituted easier governance and administration. The reorganisation of the country maintained cultural diversity, linguistic vibrancy, and glorious heritage. One of the primary concerns for the Indian government was to instil sentiments of unity and a deep sense of belonging to the country. During the national movement, Congress did take notice of the impact vernacular languages had in mobilising powerful participation towards freedom.

Immediately after independence, the same vigour had to be translated by redrawing the map of India, which was now destined for self-governance, replacing the colonial mapping, which had completely negated the local lingual, historical, and cultural dynamics of the land. The reorganisation of the States and granting self-governance to the States meant, the central government and the State government had to balance

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